bilateral or multilateral cooperation.

3. Such cooperation should be consistent with bilateral and multilateral obligations of the member states.

General Provisions

- Decisions at all levels in SAARC are taken unanimously.
- Bilateral and contentious issues are excluded from the deliberations of the Association.

List of SAARC Summits

The list of SAARC Summits are given in details hereinafter.

First Summit: 7–8 December 1985

The First Summit was attended by the Heads of States and/or Governments of Seven South Asian countries: Bangladesh, Bhutan, India, Maldives, Nepal, Pakistan and Sri Lanka. The Declaration of the Dhaka Summit enumerated the objectives and principles of the organization. The Heads of states and/or governments agreed that the guiding principles of the organization will be based on respect for principles of sovereignty, equality, territorial integrity, political independence, non-interference in internal affairs of others, and mutual benefit.

The SAARC Declaration envisaged that the Heads of States and/or Governments shall meet annually and a council of ministers consisting of the foreign ministers of the member states shall be constituted to formulate policies, to review progress of cooperation, to establish additional mechanism, and to decide on matters of general interest. The Declaration also envisioned the setting up of a Technical Committee comprising representatives of the member states for implementation of projects besides the establishment of a SAARC Secretariat.

Second Summit: Bangalore, 16–17 November 1986

The Second Summit was significant as SAARC was institutionalized through the establishment of a permanent Secretariat for